

their house? They were just one of the many families who got caught in the net when the big banks went fishing for small fry.

Exploiting College Students

If any group were to be given the title of the most sought-after by credit card companies, it would have to be the college kids. They want them while they're still young and not schooled in the ways of debt. Nineteen-year-olds are not nearly as sophisticated and wise to the ways of the world as they think they are, and they like to spend. They have little money of their own, so they barely make their payments and they're immediately caught in the web. It is worse than stealing candy from babies. It is setting them up to fail before they are even out in the working world.

Daniel was caught up in the hoopla of campus life as a freshman, and of course, he opened up a new credit card account the first weekend. The credit card company had the university name on the card, and they were right there on school grounds with their tables set up, tossing out Frisbees and free t-shirts. Daniel assumed it was all legit. And technically, it was. Daniel thought he was a responsible guy. And technically, he was. He pulled good grades and was planning to major in Finance, of all things. He made his minimum payments, and more offers came his way, with lots of nice perks. By the end of freshman year, Daniel had five cards and was five thousand dollars in debt. Daniel, and thousands of college students like him all across the country, learned their lesson the hard way. Their purchases ended up costing more than they ever imagined. They could have bought several Frisbees and t-shirts for what the credit cards ended up charging them. What little money they had in their piggy banks before they left for college has been raided by the big, bad wolf.

Credit card issuers love the campus bunch, because they turn out to be one of the most profitable groups of customers for the credit card industry. College students are not screened the same way that all other applicants are. They don't even have credit reports yet, so a credit score does not come into the picture. All they may need to qualify for a credit card is the simple fact that they are a student at a college or university. The credit card companies know they can get them hooked. Some college